Given the inherently evangelical nature of Christian toleration practised by the European coloniser, what was the practical impact, if any, of such toleration on his understanding of Indic faith systems and its forms of social organisation? Did the Christian consciousness of the coloniser influence the shaping of his education and language policies in Bharat? To answer these questions, through the course of this chapter, I have relied on first-hand material, apart from the scholarly works of Dr. Jakob De Roover, Nicolas B. Dirks[1] and others who have expounded on these questions persuasively in great detail. At this juncture, I must clarify that my discussion on these aspects will be brief and limited to locating such literature in the broader context of coloniality.

In his must-read book *Europe, India, and the Limits of Secularism*,[2] De Roover refers to a letter from the Collector and Magistrate of Karachi, Captain H.W. Preedy, to the Secretary to Government of Sindh, dated 28 November 1943, which according to me, pithily captures the essence of the British coloniser's policy of toleration. In the letter, Captain Preedy writes, 'We are bound to tolerate all religions, but not I conceive to support any but our own.' The letter is but an illustration of the clear distinction struck by the coloniser between toleration and support, wherein the former applied to the indigenous faith systems of the colonised society and the latter applied to the his own religion, Christianity.[3]

Not only did this policy of Christian toleration translate to State support being provided to the spread of Christianity (as revealed by the legislative material discussed in the previous chapter), it also translated to the coloniser approaching Indic OET systems with the same anticlerical political theology that characterised the Protestant Reformation's approach to the Catholic Church and Papal authority. As stated earlier, the consequence of this approach was that Brahmins, 'Brahminism' and 'Brahminical institutions' replaced the Pope and Catholic Church as the new objects of hatred and perpetual 'reform' at the hands of evangelical Christianity. Since temples were predominantly seen as 'Brahminical institutions', the narrative employed against pre-Christian pagan temples in Europe was pressed into service with respect to Hindu temples and their practices. For instance, the charge of 'sacred or cultic prostitution' that was employed by early Christians to malign and slander pagan temples in Europe was extended to the *Devadasi* practice in Bharat as well, which